

PROFILE

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Name Borus, Norah *Chelagat*
Sex, Birthdate Female, 06/07/1995

CONTACT DETAILS

Email, Phone norahborus68@gmail.com, +254.723217408, Mobile, +254.722793391, Mobile
Permanent Address P.O. Box 4409 Nairobi, Nairobi, 00506, KEN

DEMOGRAPHICS

Hispanic or Latino No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

LANGUAGE

English Speak, Read, Write
Other, Kiswahili First Language, Speak, Read, Write

GEOGRAPHY & CITIZENSHIP

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 19 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
US Visa I do not hold a currently valid U.S. non-immigrant Visa Issued:

CA FEE WAIVER

Fee Waiver Requested Yes, Signed: Norah Chelagat Borus
 I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

FAMILY

HOUSEHOLD

Parents Married
Home Both Parents

PARENT 1

Mother

Name Mrs. Dinah J Borus
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone +61.470295323, Mobile
Address a different address
U 1 11 Longview Ave Sandy Bay, TAS, 7005, AUS
Occupation Other, Agronomist, Unemployed
Education Graduate school
University of Nairobi, KEN 1.) Bachelors (four-year degree), 1996
University of Sydney, Sydney North Southwest 2006, Sydney, NSW, 2006, AUS, 4-year college or university, CEEB: 0867 1.) Masters (excluding MBA), 2004
University of Tasmania, Hobart, Tasmania, 7005, AUS 1.) PHD (Doctorate), 2015

PARENT 2

Father

Name Dr. Peter K Borus
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone peter.borus@yahoo.com, +254.723217408, Mobile
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Scientific researcher, Research Officer, KEMRI, Employed
Education Graduate school
University of Nairobi, KEN 1.) Bachelors (four-year degree), 1990 2.) Masters (excluding MBA), 1994
University of London, Stewart House, 32 Russell Square, London, WC1B 5DN, GBR, CEEB: 7917 1.) PHD (Doctorate), 2002

SIBLINGS

1. Fiona C Borus, Age 22, Sister, Some college/university
University of Nairobi, KEN, Bachelors (09/2010 - 09/2015)
2. Dennis K Borus, Age 21, Brother, Some college/university
University of Nairobi, KEN, Bachelors (09/2012 - 09/2017)

EDUCATION

CURRENT OR MOST RECENT SCHOOL

Precious Blood Secondary School, Riruta, P.O.BOX 21283, Nairobi, 00505, KEN, Public (02/2010 - 11/15/2013)

Counselor Ms. Elizabeth W King'ori, Deputy Principal
Email, Phone info@preciousbloodriruta.com, +254.729336365
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Interruption I have no interruption to report

OTHER COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES

COMMUNITY-BASED ORGANIZATIONS

Other, Equity Group Foundation

Counselor Mr. Michael McCreary, College Counsellor, Other Equity Group Foundation
Email, Phone Michael.McCreary@equitygroupfoundation.com, +254.763332044

GRADES

Rank 1 / 135, Unweighted

CURRENT YEAR COURSES

First Trimester

Mathematics
 English
 Kiswahili
 Physics
 Chemistry
 Biology
 Music
 Christian Religious Education

Second Trimester

Mathematics
 English
 Kiswahili
 Physics
 Chemistry
 Biology
 Music
 Christian Religious Education

Third Trimester

Mathematics
 English
 Kiswahili
 Physics
 Chemistry
 Biology
 Music
 Christian Religious Education

HONORS

Fourth best candidate out of 449,246 candidates in the KCSE National Examination, 2013	National	12
First Prize, Biology Talk; Kenya Science and Engineering Fair	National	12
1st runners-up, Alliance Mathematics Contest	National	11
Best overall student; Annual Prize Giving Day	School	9, 10, 11, 12
Teacher's Choice- Student who Makes a Difference; Annual Prize Giving Day	School	12

FUTURE PLANS

Undecided, Masters (excluding MBA)

TESTING

SAT

Critical Reading 800
01/25/2014
Taken 1

Math 710
01/25/2014
Planned 0

Writing 690
01/25/2014

SAT SUBJECT TESTS

Physics

800

06/2014

Math Level 2

750

06/2014

LEAVING EXAMS

Mathematics

A

11/2014, Actual, KCSE

English

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

Kiswahili

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

Physics

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

Chemistry

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

Biology

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

Music

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

**Christian Religious
Education**

A

11/2013, Actual, KCSE

ACTIVITIES

Music: Vocal

9, 10, 11
School
23 hr/wk, 17 wk/yr
Continue

Vice Chairlady- School Choir

Performed at school functions and at the Festivals; emerged best girl school in Regional Festivals; performed at National Gala

Student Govt./Politics

11, 12
School
6 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Vice House in Charge (2013); House In Charge(2014)

Maintaining order in the Kenya House Hostel; organizing participation in Interhouse music and sports competitions; Kenya was best overall House(2013)

Music: Instrumental

10, 11, 12, PG
School, Break
7 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Pianist- solo player and accompanist

3rd best solo pianist at National Music Festivals, piano accompanist during Interhouse Competition

Religious

9, 10, 11, 12
School
4 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Vice Chairlady, Bible Study Society

The committee organized events such as Fun Days, outsourced speakers, and organized for the Bible Study Saturday sessions.

Science/Math

11, 12
School
7 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Secretary, Math Society

Organized for extra Math tuition in all classes, and outsourced for tutors in preparation for contests; First runners-up in Alliance Contest(2012)

Academic

11, 12
School
4 hr/wk, 34 wk/yr
Continue

Vice Chairlady: Academic Committee

Bridge between students and teachers and to implement improvements to academic routine; initiated Saturday classes, outsourced for speakers

Debate/Speech

11, 12
School
3 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr
Continue

East African Model United Nations; member

Participated as delegate and security in the annual conferences, and in community service at 'Nyumba ya Wazee' retirement home.

Religious

PG
Year
11 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr
Continue

Assistant Music Director, African Inland Church

I teach the English Choir, play piano and bass guitar during service, and help organize for Music Events

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG
School
20 hr/wk, 11 wk/yr
Continue

Teaching Assistant, PACE Kenya

Volunteer teacher at St Catherine's Primary School, from January to late March, 2014.

Work (Paid)

Equity Bank intern;Equity Group Foundation Mentor

PG
Year
61 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr
Continue

Worked at the operations department of an Equity Bank branch; I mentor four 9th grade students being supported by the Foundation in Loreto High School

PREVIEW

PERSONAL ESSAY

Recount an incident or time when you experienced failure. How did it affect you, and what lessons did you learn?

The crowd stared at me impatiently; I had taken far too long to think. With a deep breath, I began in Swahili, "Gogo was one of the kindest people I have ever met."

Whispers broke out in the crowd, the elders staring at me in disbelief, and the youth barely hiding their amusement. Nevertheless, I stuttered throughout the rest of my dedication and rushed back to my seat, scattered claps following in my wake. I was furious with the crowd for laughing at me, and with myself for giving them a good reason to. The rest of the ceremony went in a blur. At tea time, I dragged myself to the smoky kitchen, trying to ignore the loud whispers and sniggers that followed me. Aunt Chelimo stood up to stretch herself just as I got in, and when she caught my eye, she said, tongue-in-cheek, "Ehe, the city girl who cannot speak Kalenjin, even at her grandmother's memorial!"

In the uncomfortable silence that ensued, Mum sieved the tea, quietly handing the thermos flask over to me to take to the Elders' tent. My great uncle, Kipchirchir, looked at me suspiciously as I approached and talked to me in Kalenjin. I replied apologetically that I couldn't understand. With a morose shake of his head, he turned back to the elders, and said in Swahili, "A tree with no roots."

A tree with no roots. I left that ceremony feeling worse than I had ever felt in my life. On our painfully silent journey back home that evening, my mind wandered back to the older days; Kalenjin was initially the secret code, spoken by my parents when they wanted to have a confidential conversation, while the languages of instruction to us were English and Swahili. I was 11 when Mum attempted to teach me Kalenjin, but my preteen self so stubbornly refused to cooperate that she gave up on me. My flawed reasoning was that we were 'urban', and therefore had Swahili for 'authenticity'. During various family gatherings and trips to *Sangurur*, our home village, I always felt a distinct desire to understand the peculiar pronunciations and intonations of Kalenjin, but I pushed it to my subconscious. However, that memorial day, it refused to stay there.

As I stayed awake in my bed that night, feeling guilty for desecrating my grandmother's memory with my ignorance, and being a stranger to my own tribal tongue, I remembered that merely having guilty feelings would not right my wrongs. It was time to change. I needed to learn Kalenjin.

From that month onwards, I tried different methods of learning, from listening to Kalenjin radio stations and putting traditional music on my playlist (this amused my friends), to instructing my parents to speak in Kalenjin only, with necessary translations. I even started reading the Bible in Kalenjin, and keeping a diary of the new words I learnt daily. Performing as a soloist in a traditional Kalenjin song during my final music assessment in High School imparted in me knowledge of our colorful traditional garb, dance and vocal ornamentation. It has not been easy; many times I feel ashamed in holding a conversation with my fluent cousins, uncles and aunts in the broken Kalenjin I have learnt. Nevertheless, I try, and I have noticed that things I used to see with indifference, such as *mursik*, our traditional drink, and Kalenjin proverbs, poems and sayings, are becoming meaningful to me.

That night after the memorial, I resolved to learn Kalenjin in a bid to prove myself; to show that I was worthy of my second name. But since then, I have realized that learning my native language is not a competition, it is a journey of self-awareness and appreciation of traditions that have been in my family for generations.

I may never pass the litmus test of Kalenjin fluency, but this tree won't stop growing its roots.

**Gogo-Grandmother*

DISCIPLINE & SCHOOL INTERRUPTION

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Did you receive an Other Than Honorable Discharge, Bad Conduct Discharge, or Dishonorable Discharge? (if applicable)

Education Interruption

I have no interruption to report

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor, felony, or other crime?

No

PREVIEW

GENERAL

Preferred start term	Preferred: Fall 2015
Admission plan	Restrictive Early Action
School Specific Fee Waivers	N/A
Financial aid	Yes
Applicants with extraordinary talent in the fine or performing arts may submit supplementary materials for review. Do you intend to submit an Art Supplement to Stanford?	No

ACADEMICS

1st academic interest	Music Science and Technology
2nd academic interest	Comparative Literature
3rd academic interest	Mechanical Engineering

ACTIVITIES

Extracurricular Activities Essay	It's 7 am. As I approach the bank, I'm glad for the meditation the forty-minute-long walk from the bus stop has offered. Once I'm inside, there is no time to pause; there are deadlines to beat, targets to reach and a report on the productivity of the tellers for the last month to write. I check my bag to ensure my "Who Moved my Cheese?" is there; since it's Fellowship Wednesday, I'll give the weekly inspirational message. A long queue has already formed at the entrance. I sigh; it's the end-month rush, so shifts invariably end at 7:15 pm. But my sigh morphs into a smile as I recall the fun times we have with my co-workers, the grins on satisfied customers' faces, and 'Liar's Poker', the amazing novel my manager, surprisingly, let me borrow. I go through the staff entry with a feeling that it'll be a good day.
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CONTACTS

Previously applied	No
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FAMILY

Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended Stanford University	No
Relative employed at Stanford University	No

SHORT QUESTIONS

Name your favorite books, authors, films, and/or artists.*	Books: Harry Potter; Liar's Poker; anything that Jonathan Franzen, Jeffrey Archer, or Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie writes. Films: Lord of the Rings 3 (my best literary adaptation) A.I. (its uniquely emotional, futuristic plot), Titanic (for all obvious reasons), Sarafina (music and activism) Artists: Ed Sheeran, Simon & Garfunkel, Passenger, Bob Dylan, Chris Tomlin
What newspapers, magazines, and/or websites do you enjoy?	Magazines and newspapers: True Love and Drum (East African women magazines), Seventeen (my guilty pleasure), Reader's Digest, Time, The Standard (local newspaper), New African Magazine Websites: collegehumour.com, cracked.com, I hate barre chords.com (advice column for guitarists), Spark People, everydayfeminism.com, The Guardian, Pinterest, TED-YouTube Channel, WordPress, vlogbrothers (YouTube video blog: Hank and John Green), Facebook

What is the most significant challenge that society faces today? (50 word limit)*

Self-interest. Kenyans complain about tribalism and corruption, yet many gladly take the job they were given because of their second names, and bribe traffic police to evade arrest. We are uncomfortable sacrificing our comfort to look at the bigger picture, thereby making us our own worst enemies in progress.

How did you spend your last two summers? (50 word limit)*

2013: Studying for KCSE; visiting our village in *Sangurur*; preparing for our Church's *Musical Experience*; secretly re-reading Harry Potter

2014: Interning at Equity Bank; preparing for my ABRSM Grade 5 piano & theory exams; playing piano/bass guitar at Church; chaperoning and mentoring at the Equity Group Foundation's 'Wings to Fly' Congress

What were your favorite events (e.g., performances, exhibits, competitions, conferences, etc.) in recent years? (50 word limit)*

- 1) The Cake Festival, 2014- It re-sparked my love for baked products;
- 2) National Science and Engineering Fair, 2013- The projects I saw, and 8 hour-long bus trips to and from the venue were unforgettable;
- 3) Master Class by Stephen Schwartz (2013) - I couldn't help fawning over the Broadway Composer.

What historical moment or event do you wish you could have witnessed? (50 word limit)*

The debut of Igor Stravinsky's controversial "The Rite of Spring" at the Théâtre des Champs-Élysées on March 29th, 1913. The unconventional performance caused such a riot that apparently the police were called to pacify the audience. It would've been interesting to watch this unique ballet, and the audience's melodramatic uproar.

What five words best describe you?

A quirky, musical, optimistic and forgetful over-thinker.

SHORT ESSAYS

Intellectual Vitality

As I finally built the correct set-up for my first Physics practical assessment, after about two lonely hours of failed attempts in the laboratory, I realized I had a deficiency. I loved mastering concepts, deriving laws of physics, and explaining the workings of vast systems like nuclear reactors. Yet, when instructed to build a simple set-up, with strings, rulers, weights and two stands, to determine gravitational force, I couldn't wrap my head round the structure of the experiment. I lacked improvisation skills and creativity in building the set-ups; accuracy in attaining values from the system and plotting appropriate and logical graphs, and dexterity in performing the experiments speedily. Mere knowledge on the concept behind the experiment wouldn't help me attain these skills; constant practice and keen observation would.

I spent countless extra hours at the lab that term. As the assessments became more complex, I'd fiddle with the balances, batteries and circuit instruments, trying to understand how they worked. I would take apart the dry cells to observe their internal structure and mechanisms. It soon became my odd hobby, and when I went home that holiday, I helped my brother repair his bicycle and our broken doorbell, things I had never bothered with. These days, I help set up the sound system in Church, which has been an amazing experience in learning about large-scale circuit systems. By focusing on what was in front of me, rather than on what I knew, I gained a new kind of curiosity in Physics.

Future Roommate

Hey! My sister, Chebichii, says I make a terrible roommate. My clothes are typically sprawled on my shoddily-made bed and piled up in my closet. In school, I got the Matron's merit points for neatness only once (I suspect they were pity points). When you combine my messiness with my chronic forgetfulness, you get my sister's worst nightmare. But I'm working on it, I promise.

Chebichii complains about my nocturnal tendencies, like reading novels well past midnight and rattling on, just as she dozes off, about articles on *The Guardian*, or TED videos I've discovered during my YouTube adventures, or ideas for new blog posts. I'm a non-believer in early sleep. I hope you don't mind a little nightly conversation and blue laptop light.

I have intense phases of specific musical obsession. 'True Colors' was the only song I played on my guitar for 4 weeks. Chebichii's probably heard my piano and vocal rendition of "Bridge over Troubled Waters" more times than she'd ever want to. But she says my infamous Beethoven's 9th Symphony phase was the worst yet- the music was my ringtone, my alarm melody, my study music-my everything.

But she does say she'll miss me. I suppose since we've slept next to each other for so long, we know and like each other too much to let our eccentricities get between us. I hope it'll be- sooner rather than later- the same for us, roomie. I can't wait to meet you ; we'll have a blast!

Love,

Norah

What matters to you, and why?

When I was 8, I dug a hole under the gate of our house, and crawled my way to freedom. At least, that's how I saw it. From the thorough beating I got afterwards, clearly Mum believed I crawled my way into trouble. That was my definition of adventure back in simpler times; escaping from the house to gang up with friends and annoy the neighborhood watchman.

Now as a 19 year old, I can't dig holes under gates, or recklessly disturb people. Having been accorded more responsibilities, I must think critically about my decisions. But what matters to me is retaining a sense of adventure. In school, I auditioned for every club, though I didn't get into most at first (my Dance Society auditions were particularly mortifying). I was on every pitch of every sport in school at least once, though I quickly realized sports were not my forte. Like everyone else, I found my own niche, primarily in music. But I didn't stop looking for adventure, whether it was by organizing for an 'Amazing Race' during the Bible Study Fun Day, playing traditional drums at the school assembly, exploring diverse forms of literature, or blogging. Planning for PACE's *Sleepless Challenge* fundraiser has been my most exciting one yet.

It gets harder as I become older not to second-guess myself. But I always try to dig holes under the doubts my mind puts up, so I can thoroughly explore, and enjoy, the opportunities this captivating world has.

AFFIRMATIONS

Honor Code	Yes
Application Withdrawal	Yes

PREVIEW